

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Six-variable reading rail

MATERIAL -> what carving or casting permits

POSTURE + ATTRIBUTE -> identity and action

PATRON + SITE -> commissioned context

COMPARISON -> similarity, difference and limit

MUST REMEMBER: Sculpture and pottery must be read through material, technique, posture, attribute, patron and site, from lost-wax casting and pottery sequences to Gandhara, Mathura, Amaravati, Gupta and Chola visual programmes.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Lost-wax and label firewall

WAX MODEL -> clay investment

HEAT -> wax leaves a cavity

MOLTEN METAL -> bronze form

MEANING -> separate from a museum label

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Pottery chronology

NEOLITHIC -> coarse hand-made ware

CHALCOLITHIC -> Ahar, Malwa and Jorwe painted wares

HARAPPAN / PGW -> separate chronological markers

NBPW -> fine early historic tableware

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Three-school matrix

GANDHARA -> grey stone, Buddhist, layered influence

MATHURA -> red stone, three religions, attributes

AMARAVATI -> limestone, Buddhist narrative, tribhanga

RULE -> compare on the same axes

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Aniconic to iconic

EMPTY THRONE / TREE / WHEEL -> symbolic presence

DEVOTIONAL CHANGE -> human image becomes central

GANDHARA + MATHURA -> overlapping early-CE contexts

CAUTION -> no uncontested sole origin

ASCI MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Gupta bridge

SARNATH -> cream sandstone

BODY -> subtle modelling and thin drapery

SULTANGANJ -> late or post-Gupta caution

BRIDGE -> restraint before denser temple programmes

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Nataraja chronology

AIHOLE -> early known antecedent

CHOLA -> canonical portable bronze

TEMPLE PROCESSION -> ritual mobility

RULE -> peak is not origin

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Nataraja attribute map

DAMARU / FIRE -> creation and destruction

ABHAYA / RAISED FOOT -> reassurance and release

APASMARA -> ignorance subdued

AUREOLE -> recurring time

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Lion-bull evidence ladder

HARAPPAN -> bull visible, meaning unrecoverable

RAMPURVA -> inscribed lion, uninscribed bull

SARNATH -> animals inside a Buddhist-imperial system

TEMPLE -> Nandi, Yali and Vyala gain placed roles

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Temple animal placement

NANDI -> axial pavilion before Shiva

YALI -> composite guardian on southern pillars

VYALA -> lion-bodied hybrid at Khajuraho

DISTINCTION -> building, guardian and motif

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Gandhara, Mathura and Amaravati differ by material, religious scope and visual grammar; symbolic Buddha representation preceded broadly overlapping Gandhara-Mathura iconic production, so sole-origin claims are unsafe.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Social-evidence test

FIGURE -> dancer, musician, teacher or couple

PATRON -> selected what became visible

CLAIM -> valued activity or ritual idiom

LIMIT -> not a census of society

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Pashupati, Mother Goddess and Priest-King are modern Harappan labels; Chola bronzes canonised rather than originated Nataraja, and temple sculpture records patron-selected visibility rather than a social census.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Sculpture answer spine

DEFINE -> school, object or symbol

EVIDENCE -> material, posture, attribute and site

COMPARE -> period or regional workshop

QUALIFY -> attribution, priority and social inference